

THE PAYSON MORNING SCROLL

MADE EXCLUSIVELY FOR THE MOGOLLON'S HEARTH GUESTS

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

THE GREYBEARDS OF HIGH HROTHGAR — PUBLISHER & PROPRIETOR

PAYSON, ARIZONA · FREDAS, THE 9TH OF FROSTFALL (FRIDAY, OCTOBER 9, 2026)

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Gandy shields his eyes from the bright patches while Maevy stalks a grasshopper across the deck.

SKIES O'ER THE HOLD

82° / 60°

Partly cloudy

Sunrise 6:26 AM · Sunset 5:58 PM

Tomorrow — PM thunderstorms, 73/58

OVERHEARD LAST NIGHT

A traveler asked the barkeep if tomorrow's storm would spoil the cruisers' parade. The barkeep only shrugged: "Aye — the wagons will gleam all the brighter for the washing."

THE MOON'S RECKONING



Yesterday
Waning Crescent



Tonight
New Moon



Tomorrow

waning toward the new moon

9th of Frostfall = October 9

Months run one-for-one all year

Sundas=Sun ... Loredas=Sat

AROUND THE HOLDS · THE WEEK AHEAD

Wagons Gleam, Cannons Boom: A Grand Weekend Rides In



Payson, Ariz.

PAYSON — Hail, friend of the Hearth! Friday strolls over the Rim with sun on its shoulders and a promise of bigger weather behind it — savor today's 82 degrees, for the sky means business

tomorrow. The Beeline Cruisers roll their gleaming wagons out of Rumsey Park this afternoon for the thirty-third annual cruise, then line the Green Valley Park grass Saturday for the big show. Fort Verde answers with cannon and drum for its seventieth Fort Verde Days down in Camp Verde, and Sedona takes to the air with vintage warbirds at Wings & Wheels. Read on — and lay thy cloak where thou canst find it, for Saturday brings rain.



The Beeline Cruisers roll their gleaming wagons onto the green for the thirty-third annual show.

HAPPENING IN THE HOLDS TODAY



Payson

— **Beeline Cruise-In Friday Cruise** — the Motor Club's 33rd annual weekend rolls out of Rumsey Park at 3:30 PM on a cruise through northwest Payson, then the Burger Burn cookout ~4:30 PM; free for spectators.

— **Karaoke Party** — 7–10 PM at Johnny's Midtown, 3870 AZ-260 in Star Valley; free weekly karaoke with B&B Music.



Show Low

— **The Locals Market** — 3 PM at the Pinedale Public Library; local vendors and makers.

— **Paint and Pop Art Fun** — 6:30 PM, 614 S. Porter Rd, Show Low; a pop-art painting session.



Prescott

— **Prescott Antique Show & Vintage Market** — day one, 12–5 PM at the Rodeo Grounds, 840 Rodeo Drive; 50+ dealers, proceeds fund historic preservation; early-bird 12–2 (\$15), general 2–5 (\$10).

— **Photographs & Memories: A Jim Croce Tribute** — 7 PM at the Elks Theatre, 117 E. Gurley St.

— **Star Party** — 6:30–9 PM with the Prescott Astronomy Club at the Highlands Center for Natural History; free.

THE DAYS AHEAD

• Sat, Oct. 10

— **Beeline Cruise-In Classic Car Show** — 7 AM–3 PM on the grass at Green Valley Park, 600 S. Green Valley Pkwy; classic cars, trucks, rat rods and low riders; charity raffles, food vendors, Town of Payson entertainment; free.

— **Fort Verde Days** — Saturday–Sunday, 10 AM–4 PM at Fort Verde State Historic Park, 125 E. Hollamon St, Camp Verde; the 70th annual homecoming: flag ceremonies, artillery demos, living-history re-enactors, Dutch-oven cooking, the Saturday-morning parade, pony rides and bounce houses.

— **Sedona Wings & Wheels 2026** — 9 AM–4 PM at the Sedona Airport; car show (2026 theme: MOPAR) plus vintage aircraft, aviation demos, airplane and helicopter rides; free gate — bring a non-perishable food item or \$2 for the Sedona Community Food Bank.

• Sun, Oct. 11

— **Sedona Arts Festival** — day two, 10 AM–4 PM at Sedona Red Rock High School; 35th annual; juried artists, food trucks, live music; \$5/day (35th-birthday pricing); proceeds fund arts education.

• Mon, Oct. 12

— **Open Mic Night** — 4–7 PM at THAT Brewery & Pub, 3270 AZ-87, Pine; every 2nd and 4th Monday, hosted by the Pine-Strawberry Fuel Reduction team — tips benefit fuel-reduction work.

• Tue, Oct. 13

— **Trail Day Volunteer Build** — 7 AM–12 PM in Pine (dirt turnout parking off AZ-87 just before town); trail clearing with the Pine-Strawberry Fuel Reduction team; tools provided, bring water and gloves.

• Thu, Oct. 15

— **Gary Allan with Julie Eddy** — 7:30 PM (doors 6:30) at Findlay Toyota Center, 3201 N. Main St, Prescott Valley; clear-bag policy.

— **A Band Called Honalee** — 7 PM, 301 S. McLane, Payson; a Peter, Paul & Mary tribute.

QUESTS OF THE HEARTH

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Two torches plus the socket test piece — overdue; test-fit before the full run.
- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Measure the flame bulb and socket, then settle the final wall-sconce design — overdue.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Paint them faux wrought iron (or wood), UV-seal for the sun, then hang — due Saturday.

By Saturday: torches hung and burning — the walls have waited long enough.



The torch sconces take shape; Saturday is hanging day.

WORD FROM THE PAYSON HOLD



The **Payson Town Council** holds its next regular meeting **Wednesday, Oct. 14, at 4:00 PM** in the Town Hall Council Chambers, 303 N. Beeline Highway. The agenda had not been posted as of Friday morning — agendas go up at least 24 hours ahead, so check back Tuesday.

The council's last meeting was Sept. 23; no meeting took place this week. [Meetings page](#) · [Granicus archive](#) ([agendas](#), [minutes](#), [videos](#))

MERCHANT OF THE HOLD

Buffalo Bar & Grill · Payson



The signature game-meat sandwich, borne high through the mead hall.

A rustic cowboy-themed bar and grill on the Beeline — full bar, cold beer, and hearty American pub fare, famous for its fresh-ground Buffalo Burger piled high with green chiles, the way the regulars order it. Fridays belong to the Fish Fry, Saturdays to the Top Sirloin Steak Dinner for Two, and every night the place hums like a mead hall — some small frost-spell keeps the taps pouring cold.

“The beer was cold, the waitress was very pleasant and bartender was quick to serve us.”

— a [TripAdvisor review](#) by [W2994KCtheresap](#) (Golden Valley, AZ), March 2026

311 S. Beeline Hwy, Payson | Sun–Thu 11 AM–9 PM, Fri–Sat 11 AM–10 PM | (928) 474-3900 | moderate (\$\$); \$5.95 weekday lunch | Good-to-know: family-friendly (kids’ menu, highchairs), Thirsty Thursdays drink specials, live music Friday–Saturday · [their scrying-mirror page](#) (other travelers call it a ‘website’)

Why the Hearth sends you: The Hearth sends you here because no guest should leave the Hold without tasting the Buffalo Burger with green chiles — the closest thing to a proper Nord feast on the Beeline.

STORIES AROUND THE RIM

HE WAS HERE TEN MINUTES AGO



The barrow door stands open. He was here ten minutes ago.

Word came down the Verde trail at dawn, carried by a trapper with frost in his beard and a story nobody will believe twice.

He'd seen a hooded figure cross the old trail above the pines — carrying something wrapped in cloth that glimmered like moonlight on water. At a single spoken word the ravens rose off the trees in a black wave. The figure turned up the hill toward the old barrow. By the time the trapper reached the bend, not ten minutes later, the trail was empty — and the barrow's ancient stone door stood open, breathing a faint glow from the dark.

Mabel doesn't believe a word of it. The rider who came down after claims the figure rode a horse; the trapper swears he walked. Both agree on one thing: whatever glimmered under that cloth, it wasn't from around here.

Some say the Dragonborn went into the barrow for what the old kings left behind. Some say he already came out the other side. All we know is this: ten minutes. He was here ten minutes ago.

TALES FROM THE TREELINE

THE GREAT SAGE FREEZE



The great sage freeze — Flurry's steadiest breath yet.

Mabel (a wood elf) had a plan: winter is coming, her sage must be dried, and Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) is the Hold's walking icebox. So on a drizzly morning she enlisted him to freeze-dry the whole harvest — a slow, careful breath, no zigzags, no funny business.

Flurry drew himself up tall, took aim at the sage bundles hanging from her garden trellis, and breathed out the steadiest, proudest ice-mist of his young life. The sage froze to perfection, glittering like diamonds on a Nord shield.

That was when Henny (the Hearth's chicken), mid-beetle-chase, skidded through the garden at full waddle and slid, feathers and all, across the wet grass — straight into Flurry's ice-mist. She emerged glazed like a pastry, froze mid-step, and then, unbothered professional that she is, caught her reflection in a frozen puddle and began to preen.

Mabel sighed the sigh of the only responsible adult in the forest. Gus, arriving with an empty pie dish, took one look, broke off a leaf of ice-sage, tasted it, and declared it "minty."

The Hold's first frost-dried herbs. Mabel calls it a disaster. The mead hall calls it seasoning.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Fredas be free of bears, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ☒